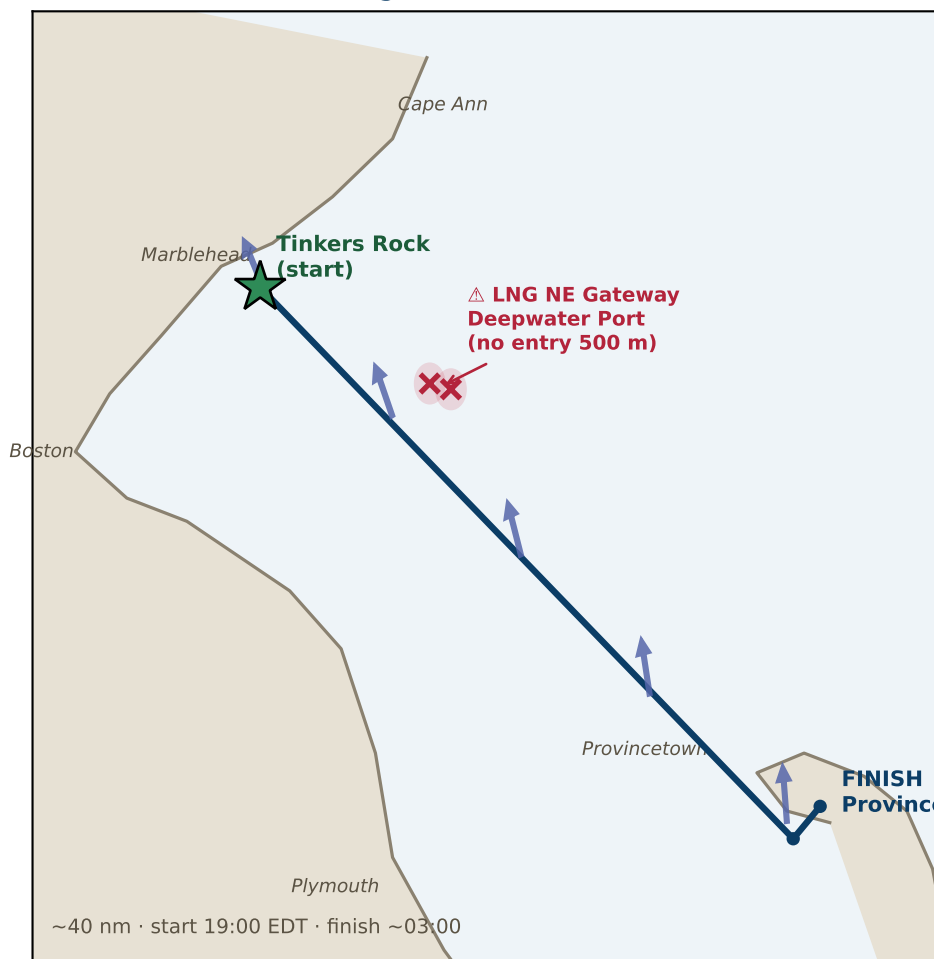


Marblehead → Provincetown — Overnight Race Weather

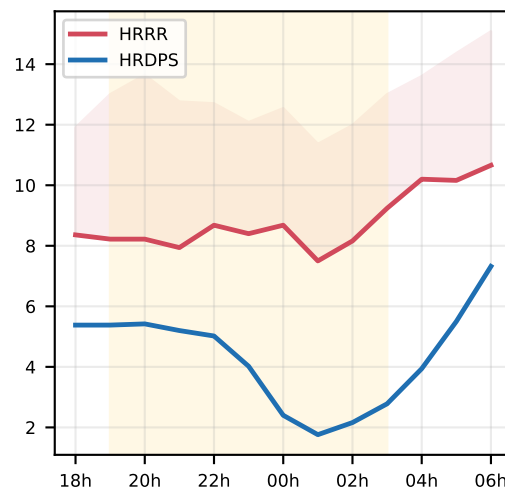
Friday 2026-07-17, 19:00 EDT start · ~03:00 Sat finish · ~40 nm SE across Massachusetts & Cape Cod Bays

Models: NOAA HRRR 3 km + Environment Canada HRDPS 2.5 km (Open-Meteo) · generated 2026-07-16 19:52Z · ~24 h lead — refine race morning

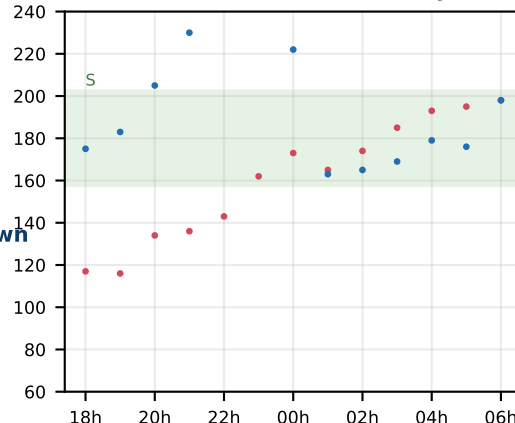
Route & overnight wind (HRRR mean arrows)



Course-mean wind (kt)



Wind dir (° from, mid-bay)

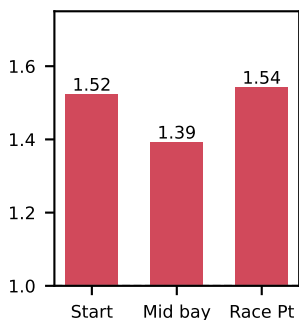


Overnight synopsis

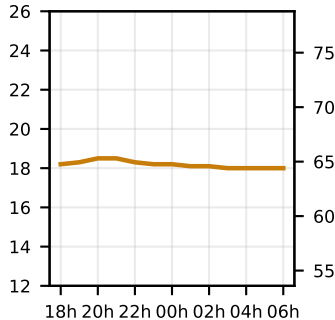
Light, weak-gradient southerly night (flat ~1016 mb, no front). The models AGREE on the overnight: the wind fills S/SW 8-12 kt offshore, a starboard-tack reach that gradually frees toward Race Point, seas ≤ 2 ft. They SHARPLY DISAGREE on the start: NOAA HRRR has SE ~10 kt (a reach/beat down the rhumb) while Canada HRDPS shows a NW land-breeze ~7 kt (offshore), dying to near-calm by ~01:00 before the southerly fills — opposite first-leg angles. HRDPS has verified better locally this season, but at a post-sunset transition neither is reliable: sail the breeze that's actually on the water, then get offshore into the steadier southerly. Hour-by-hour, tactics, tide and hazards overleaf.

Conditions at a glance

Gust factor (HRRR)



Air temp on the water (°C)



Gusts — steady, modest

HRRR gust factor ~1.4-1.5, peaks ~15-16 kt over ~9 kt mean; gustiest mid-bay/Race Pt pre-dawn. HRDPS gives no gust field. CAPE 0 + only ~11-15 kt at 925/850 hPa → no convective or momentum-driven gusts (unlike a daytime sea-breeze). Plan smooth, not puffy.

Sea state — benign

~0.2 m / 0.7 ft short-period wind chop (NWS ANZ231/233 seas $\leq 1-2$ ft). SST ~21°C / 69°F. Flat water — the limiter is wind, not waves.

Temperature — mild & near-steady on the water

~18°C / 64-65°F all night on the course; the sea moderates it (drops only ~1°F offshore; up to ~10°F near the P-town shore). Warm water under cooler air keeps it damp → reinforces the fog watch. Layers for damp, not cold.

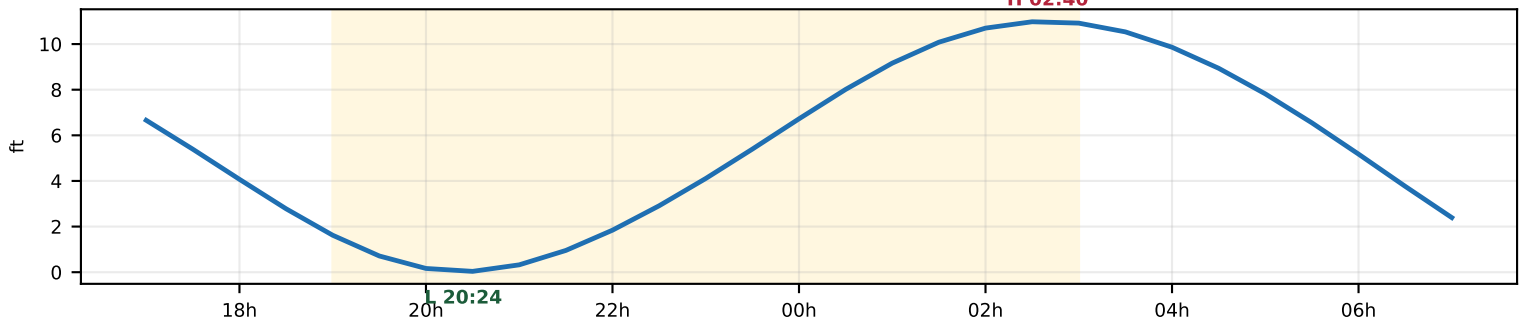
Tactics, Strategy & Timing

Marblehead → Provincetown · Fri 2026-07-17 overnight

Corridor wind — dir°/kt, H=HRRR (top) / C=HRDPS (bottom)

Time ET	Start (Tinkers Rk)	Off Nahant	Mid Mass Bay	Stellwagen edge	Race Pt / P-town
19:00 H C	128/10 285/8	117/7 268/7	116/8 183/4	140/8 164/5	158/8 161/3
21:00 H C	127/7 309/6	125/7 311/6	136/10 230/2	145/8 180/5	157/8 192/6
23:00 H C	146/7 321/4	150/8 333/4	162/9 319/1	170/10 212/4	170/8 213/8
01:00 H C	189/3 268/1	175/7 127/1	165/8 163/1	179/10 204/2	184/10 221/4
03:00 H C	157/5 155/3	177/10 160/4	185/11 169/3	186/11 175/2	188/9 203/2
05:00 H C	197/11 190/5	189/9 186/6	195/11 176/5	192/11 166/5	190/9 180/6

Tide at Boston (proxy) — start ≈ low slack, finish ≈ high slack



Tactics & strategy

① Start (19:00-21:00) — models disagree, so read the water

HRRR: SE ~10 kt (reach/close-hauled). HRDPS: NW land-breeze ~7 kt (offshore), dying to calm ~01:00. Opposite angles — don't pre-commit. Sail the actual dock breeze; whatever it is it's LIGHT (≤8 kt). Get clear air off the line, then work OFFSHORE — the Marblehead shore is the light trap.

② The crossing (21:00-01:00) — reach in the filling southerly

Both models fill S/SW 8-12 kt offshore — a starboard reach that frees as the wind veers right. Pressure lives offshore/south (mid-bay ~10 kt vs shore 2-6). Commit south; stay on the pressure side, don't over-stand north toward Cape Ann.

③ ⚠️ LNG Northeast Gateway — hard avoid

Two STL buoys at ~42.40 N (−70.60/−70.59) sit just N of the direct line. NO ENTRY within 500 m, no anchoring within ~1 nm. The rhumb passes ~5 nm south — staying on/south of the line is both faster (more breeze) and legal.

④ Race Point & finish (01:00-03:00) — the tide gate

S/SSW 8-11 kt, gusts to 15 into Cape Cod Bay. Flood builds to Boston high 02:45 ≈ finish. Round Race Point BEFORE ~02:45 to carry the flood in; later boats meet the building ebb. Finish current itself is minor (near high slack).

⑤ Night & hazards

Dark — thin crescent sets early, so nav by instruments, watches + lights set. Fog watch: July S-flow over cool water; NWS not flagging Fri night but recheck AM. Seas ≤2 ft, no Small Craft Advisory expected.

Confidence: moderate on the overnight reach + tide timing (models agree); low on the exact start (transition + lead). Re-run race morning + pre-start.